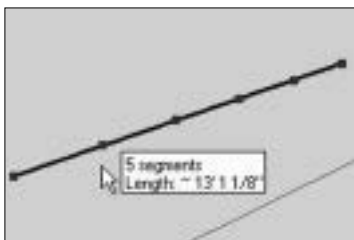


sor over the line and SketchUp will tip you with a tag that shows you exactly how many segments it would be divided into if you click there, and what the length of each individual segment would be.

- Click on the line when you see the required number of divisions. The line will be divided into equal, joined line segments.



SketchUp shows you the points at which the line will be segmented

The tooltips that tell you whether you're on midpoints, end-points, edge, etc. are thanks to the unique "inferencing" system in SketchUp. To understand that, turn to, *Inferences in SketchUp* later in this chapter.

2.2.6 Drawing 2D Shapes

The next step after you've figured out how to draw lines, is to figure how to draw figures with lines.

Making Faces

In SketchUp, 2D shapes are called *Face Entities*. It is essential to be able to draw faces first, because every 3-Dimensional model is actually constituted by several different 2D faces.

You can draw faces with the Line Tool, Arc Tool, Freehand Tool, Rectangle Tool, Circle tool or Polygon Tool.

2D shapes can be created in 3D perspective but if you wish to make things look really flat, like paper, when you're drawing, you can shift to a Top camera view by choosing *Camera > Standard Views > Top*. Also choose *Camera > Parallel Projection* to ensure that your view isn't distorted by the default Perspective view.

Using the Line Tool to create a face

Just as we go about creating shapes on paper, the elementary way to create faces in SketchUp is to use the basic element—the line.

Let us try and create a triangle using the Line Tool.